

THE DINER STANDOFF

Draft 1 - branching sequence

INT. ROUTE 66 DINER - NIGHT

The overhead sign buzzes and flickers through the window. SAM has a revolver leveled across the counter. JAMIE hasn't moved from the corner booth in what feels like a full minute, palms flat against the formica like she's holding the table down.

SAM

You shouldn't have come back here.

JAMIE

I didn't have a choice.

Somewhere in the kitchen a fryer timer goes off and nobody moves to answer it. Everything in the room is waiting on Sam.

Does he pull the trigger, or does he lower the gun and try to talk his way out of it? Pulling the trigger drops us straight into Blood on the Floor. Trying to talk it out instead lands us in An Uneasy Truce.

BLOOD ON THE FLOOR

EXT. HARBOR DOCKS - CONTINUOUS

The shot cracks through the diner before anyone can stop it. Sam is out the back within seconds, Jamie's weight over one shoulder, the gun still warm in his other hand, and he doesn't slow down until the docks swallow him and the sirens are just noise behind him.

Whatever was between them before, it isn't there anymore.

From here, does he make the clean getaway, or does something pull him back for Jamie one more time? Running gets us to The Old Warehouse. Turning back sends us into The Getaway Gone Wrong.

AN UNEASY TRUCE

INT. ROUTE 66 DINER - NIGHT (CONT'D)

The gun comes down an inch, then another, until it's resting flat on the counter instead of pointed at anything. Jamie lets out a breath she's clearly been holding since the cold open.

JAMIE

Okay. Okay, just - leave it there.

Neither of them says what almost just happened. But something between them has shifted, and it isn't going back to what it was.

THE OLD WAREHOUSE

INT. OLD WAREHOUSE - LATER

Sam ducks between rows of shipping crates and doesn't come out again. By the time the first responders reach the docks he's three blocks away and hasn't looked back once. Whatever comes after this isn't part of tonight - the sequence ends here.